David Michael Slater

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Fiction, nonfiction, theater - for children, teens, and adults.



About David

David Michael Slater writes across sharply different audiences and tones. His work includes playful picture books, comic chapter-book adventures, unsettling fantasy, dark family novels, and nonfiction that questions familiar assumptions about schools and public life. His books often return to the power of language, moral choices, and the ways people respond to authority. He is also a musical-theater librettist and fiction editor of JUDITH MAGAZINE.

The Vanishing won the American Writing Awards' 2022 Fiction Book of the Year. It was optioned for film by Chris Columbus's 26th Street Pictures in 2023.

At a glance

Based in Lake Oswego, Oregon

Books More than forty, for children, teens, and adults

Background Thirty years teaching in public schools

Editorial work Fiction editor, JUDITH MAGAZINE

Forthcoming UK edition

The UK edition of *The Vanishing*, titled *The Invisible Girl*, will be published by Blackspring Press Group in December 2027.

Media contact

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www.davidmichaelslater.com

Author biographies

Biographies for event listings, interviews, and editorial coverage.

One sentence

David Michael Slater writes fiction, nonfiction, and theater for children, teens, and adults, and lives in Lake Oswego, Oregon.

Short biography

David Michael Slater is the author of more than forty books for children, teens, and adults. His work ranges from playful picture books and fantasy adventures to dark comic novels and nonfiction about education and public life. The Vanishing won the American Writing Awards' 2022 Fiction Book of the Year and was optioned for film by Chris Columbus's 26th Street Pictures in 2023. A retired public school teacher, Slater lives in Lake Oswego, Oregon.

Extended biography

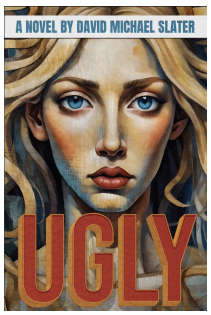
David Michael Slater is the author of more than forty books for children, teens, and adults. His fiction includes the multigenerational tragicomedy UGLY, the Jewish coming-of-age novel Fun & Games, the historical fantasy The Vanishing, and the YA thriller Sparks. His books for children include The Boy & the Book, Cheese Louise!, and the Mysterious Monsters series. His nonfiction includes We're Doing It Wrong and Wingnuts.

The Vanishing won the American Writing Awards' 2022 Fiction Book of the Year and was optioned for film by Chris Columbus's 26th Street Pictures in 2023. Its UK edition, titled The Invisible Girl, is forthcoming from Blackspring Press Group in December 2027.

Slater serves as fiction editor of JUDITH MAGAZINE. He also wrote the libretto and co-created the story for SHOCKED, a musical about Stanley Milgram and his obedience experiments, with composer and lyricist Ernest Ebell. He taught in public schools for thirty years before retiring. Born and raised in Pittsburgh's Squirrel Hill neighborhood, he now lives in Lake Oswego, Oregon.

Selected fiction

Adult and crossover novels. Full descriptions, samples, and buying links are on each book page.



UGLY

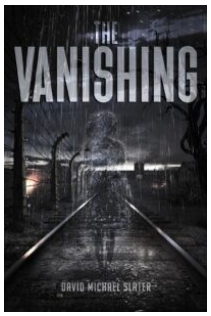
Adults | Tragicomedy and family saga

Three generations of women move from prewar London to the American heartland and Hollywood in a darkly comic story of beauty, power, and defiance.

Audiobook narrated by Lauren Irwin.

Library Tales Publishing / Simon & Schuster | ISBN 9798894410043

Book details and editions



The Vanishing

Teens and adults | Historical fantasy

A Jewish girl becomes invisible after a traumatic loss and turns her new power toward resistance and the rescue of her closest friend in Nazi Europe.

UK edition: The Invisible Girl, Blackspring Press Group, December 2027.

Library Tales Publishing / Simon & Schuster | ISBN 9798894410210

Intense Holocaust themes; may not suit younger or highly sensitive readers.

Book details and editions



Fun & Games

Adults | Dark comedy and coming of age

In the 1980s, Jonathan Schwartz tries to survive adolescence in a family whose outrageous behavior conceals faith, grief, secrets, and fear. A revised 10th anniversary edition is available.

Library Tales Publishing / Simon & Schuster | ISBN 9798894410180

Book details and editions

Young readers

A teen thriller, a wordless picture book, and an early chapter-book adventure.



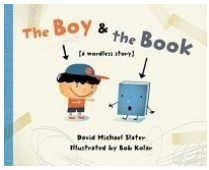
Sparks

Teens | Speculative thriller

Two teenagers go on the run to uncover the truth about a sinister home for children, a neighboring mansion, and the forces determined to keep their secrets.

Fitzroy Books / Regal House Publishing | ISBN 9781646031733

Book details and editions



The Boy & the Book

Children | Wordless picture book

An enthusiastic little boy and a library book develop an unexpected relationship in a story told through pictures.

Charlesbridge | Illustrated by Bob Kolar

Book details and editions



Bigfoot!

Children | Early chapter book

The Mattigan siblings search for a creature their famous father insists cannot exist. The first of six funny, mysterious adventures.

Incorgnito Publishing Press | Mysterious Monsters, Book 1

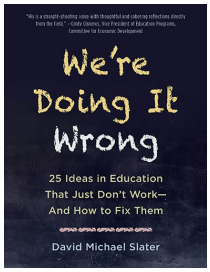
Book details and editions

Explore more titles and series by audience or reading taste.

Browse the reading guide

Nonfiction and theater

Questions about education, public life, and obedience.



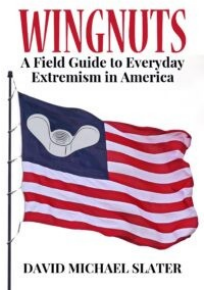
We're Doing It Wrong

Nonfiction | Education

A teacher examines twenty-five familiar ideas in education, asking how they fail students and how schools could change.

Skyhorse Publishing

Book details and editions



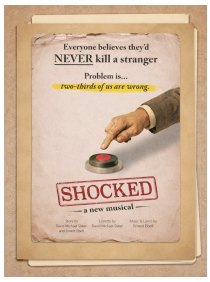
Wingnuts

Nonfiction | Politics and public life

A field guide to everyday extremism that challenges readers across the political spectrum to reconsider how they argue and what they believe.

Sunbury Press

Book details and editions



SHOCKED

Theater | A new musical in development

A musical inspired by Stanley Milgram's obedience experiments, exploring conscience, authority, and ordinary people's choices under pressure. Libretto by David Michael Slater; music and lyrics by Ernest Ebell; story co-created by Slater and Ebell.

Official SHOCKED website

Interview topics and press links

Suggested starting points for conversations with David.

Writing across audiences

How do you decide whether a story belongs to children, teens, or adults, and what changes when you write for each?

Humor and difficult subjects

How do you find the point where a joke can reveal something painful without making light of it?

Fantasy and historical memory

What can an invisible protagonist reveal about resistance, friendship, and survival in The Vanishing?

Thirty years in classrooms

Which assumptions about education did your teaching experience lead you to question?

Jewish stories and literary community

How do Jewish identity, memory, and your work at JUDITH MAGAZINE inform the stories you tell and publish?

Obedience on the stage

What drew you to Stanley Milgram, and what can musical theater bring to the question of why people obey?

Selected coverage

Jewish Review - A conversation about UGLY and its three generations of women.

Kirkus Reviews - Review of The Vanishing, September 2022.

Education Week - A teacher's view of We're Doing It Wrong, August 2018.

Deadline - Report on the 2023 film option for The Vanishing.

Photos and covers

The accompanying media folder includes the current author portrait, selected book covers, a SHOCKED poster, and plain-text biographies. For alternate images, credits, interviews, or review-copy requests, contact David directly.

david@davidmichaelslater.com